

Medford School Committee Regular Meeting Notes - May 18, 2020 - via Zoom

Attendance - Roll Call - 7-0 - Salute the Flag

Kretz - approved May 4 -

Motion for approval - graham/mclaughlin - Roll Call - 7-0 - passes

No Sec report

Report of Committees -

May 4th - Cmt of Whole - Pre Budget Meeting - graham/van - minutes passes

Special Mtg - - May 7th - Budget related topics/ DLP - Van/ motion to approve with additional wording - motion passes

Behavioral Health - McLaughlin - we will be alternating on 3rd Thursday of Month - we have a mtg this Thursday - Behavioral Health - Motion to approve - graham/kreatz - motion passes

Engagement & Strategic - Graham - PR to go out for public - 3 roundtables Wed/May 27th, Member McLaughlin - who is doing PR?

Graham - Supt Office?

Supt - press release should be ready to go out tomorrow - our 1st meeting - SOA is this Wed - as a Committee of the Whole

McLaughlin - SOA

Graham - delay in deadline from DESE - \$ may not materialize - table it until we have more info

McLaughlin - don't want to use this Wed for the fall scenarios instead?

Graham - more time for folks to

Mayor - little more

Ruseau - table

Mayor - tabled until we get more info

McLaughlin - make motion to share pr /Kreatz -

Ruseau - fine with pr - can't discuss or reply

Motion to approve? Motion passes

Graham - 1st roundtable may 27th - topics

McLaughlin - point of information - will it be recorded? - for point of reference?

Patrick - can you assist?

As long as I'm invited, I can record

Van der Kloot - how do we subdivide SC in the breakout rooms - do we express our interest?

Facilitator and note takers

Supt - admin team eager to be involved in sessions - we will discuss tomorrow in admin mtg - to record - actively involved in roundtables and we can meet to update you

Mayor - we will start those meetings next Wed

Van /Graham - motion passes

Mayor - Special mtg - May 14th - DLP and MOA - in exec session and reported out -

Van/Kreatz - motion passes

Rules Policy - Mar 20th - Ruseau - Mar 3rd met & provided a recommendation for SC - standardized format for all policies going forward - up to date policies - any questions?

5

Van /Graham - motion passes

Community Participation -

Supt - Charlene Douglas

Mayor - Questions - MedfordSC@medford.k12.ma.us

Charlene - as elected voice - thank those SC members who voted for it and for those who voted now - we the teachers of Medford appreciate your concern - we agree that PD is needed and we want to work with you. We all know that schools will not look the same in 2020. PD was listed in the 1st and 2nd DLP - parents can't be at negotiation table, but we want to reach all families - only 30% usually participate

(Get her notes)

We need to work together, collaborate, address tech for all, needs of our teachers with young children at home, social emotional needs for all needs of our MPS community - WE must support together united as one we will win

Mayor - tough vote - really appreciate your comments - we want to work together

Charlene - want to work together - many teachers here - we want to do what's best for the students

McLaughlin - to the teachers/families out there - this is hard for everyone - 7 weeks when the world was turned upside down - the social emotional needs are real - we have teachers dropping packets at homes - see teachers to feel connected - Out of district students into zoom sessions to make them feel a part of the community - work together - collaboration is important - dangers of social media - they don't get taken back - people look to us as the leaders in the community - CCSR - send thank you to our teachers - critical - community leaders might not be able to respond due to legal issues - while that's hard for constituents to hear - family and community engagement very important to me - Practice kindness to improve education for all

Van der Kloot - thank you for speech and timeline - costs that teachers have incurred on their own - an incredibly difficult and unprecedented time - many parents prefer in person experience and they are thankful the teachers have stepped up - we all want parent engagement - but executive session - we are in this together - work as a team

Charlene - ty both for your support

Kreatz - I ditto what McLughlin and Van said - this situation has never happened before - some districts are just starting work on DLP - we are on our 2nd one

Graham - One of the things we talked about, before election, labor night - how we negotiate? We will negotiate best when we are all at the table best - Excited to collaborate and think differently about these negotiations - innovate -

Supt - TY Pres Douglas and teachers for all the work you are doing during covid - continue to work together as a team -

Ruseau - Thank you everyone - if we don't like what's in the bread, the bread is already baked - if open negotiations are the way to go, then maybe we should try it

Jaime Taylor - 47 Burnside St - DLP - 2 live classes a week - with more than 1 child - difficult to revamp for last 4 weeks - adding stress to face to face - attendance is now being taken? Parents who don't want their child to be a part of google meets?

Marwa Darwish - 5 Cabot Road - Continue remote learning for fall 2020 - live with vulnerable family members please consider this

McLaughlin - make motion to community engagement sub committee seconded by Van - emails will be moved to round tables as well as emails in the info@medford.k12.ma.us that relate to roundtables

Graham - shared to info@medford.k12.ma.us - so people don't have to wait until next Wed

McLaughlin - to that end, that info also emails would also be shared with SC members and the round tables?

Motion by Member McLaughlin /Graham - motion passes

Mayor - any other emails? Any other Community participations

Supt updates and comments - (see her remarks)

Sophie, Councillor Scarpelli, Hyatt Place

Especially large Haitian population at MHS - students were going to do a video - they did an event last year On behalf of the members of the community I just wanted to make these remarks

Certificate for Albert

Thank Molly Laden for her leadership

Thankful that DLP is in place - continue to work together

McLaughlin - happy Haitian Flag Day - school supplies donation - again this Friday, there will also have school supplies available

Supt - PTO collaborated together - McGlynn School

McLaughlin -Haines Square - on city website, McGlynn, 30 Forest St

Ruseau/Van - motion passes

Covid Update - Toni Wray - number of cases continue to plateau - 2 positive trends - % of patient hospitalizations decreasing as well as death - only 2 increase from (9) cases - of pediatric systemic response - few cases of it - DPH is requiring Dr report it to trace it - Gov Baker announced Phased Reopening - each phase lasts 3 weeks as long as trends go to positive direction - considered Safer at Home -

Senior Class Events - Paul D / Dr. Cushing - acknowledge people - never our intent to cancel grad or prom - safely - David Blauch, Lisa K, Joe and Nancy, Chad, Lisa E, Officers of the Sr Class - plan of how to pick things up - we are getting new info now about gatherings - 161 responses from students (303) - overwhelming they are looking for a live event than a virtual event - senior parade - many discussions - equity - not everyone has a car - our plan would be to do similar to elementary - route on main streets with caps and gowns - Hormel - spacing appropriately - June 1st and 2nd - cap and gown distribution - plus their health records and we need their books/devices back - Prom - difficult when you plan - year in advance - weddings have been rescheduled - so using gym instead so students get what they deserve

Van der Kloot - How would you do the parade route? What about those who don't live in Medford? Will they be asked to attend?

Paul D - we'd want to get as many students here

Van der Kloot - inclusive of all students - 10 AM?

Paul D - placeholder - long parade route - 10 AM we were looking for a less traffic time

Peter Cushing - MPD - time that won't interfere in traffic - stay as much together - not 2 parades in city

Van der Kloot - high school students - grand is in the evening - thought a 7 PM parade?

Paul D - times are just an ideas

Van der Kloot - appreciation for the plan

McLaughlin - excited for these options for our seniors to celebrate - encourage businesses to celebrate - PTO Jackie Falco & Celia Lee - adopt a senior - Seniors were all adopted, wait list - exciting project as well

Graham - makes a lot of sense - we did this together with parents and students, facebook live session - one request that we don't hold it

Cushing - everything is designed to be flexible - but we want parade and adopt the senior - we will announce Spirit Week - to commemorate vets -decorate driveway & door to represent the class of 2020 - momentous occasion for the class

Paul D - PTO thank you for Adopt a Senior program

Kyle Nease - senior - 48 Clewley Road - we do appreciate all of your support - we are disappointed as to how we've been treated - what we are upset about - lack of communication - heartfelt message - Apr 16th - video from Asst Principals - very upset in late March and continued June 15th , not May 29th - May 4th - email - your last day of school is May 29th, but nothing else - not asking for a lot - not a grad or prom - socially distanced graduation - we 7hear rumors about the rest of the year was to end Teachers have been excellent - zoom calls have been something to look forward too - I don't want my comments to reflect on them at all - admin wished they'd follow suit - Thank you

McLaughlin - articulate presentation - profound - sorry for all the seniors and that things improve

Graham - one of the things SC can do - how do we communicate - we have a subcommittee on it - one of the most important things I ran for - we will do better - thank you - I'm told that Grad is one of the most fun events for SC

Paul D - I want to apologize if that's how you feel - I try to get more exact info - that falls on me - If I've been lacking, I do apologize - my hope is that we will do better

Kyle - a little bit more open and inclusion -

Mayor - positive note for seniors - Rotary bought huge banner up at City Hall - we will keep working on it

Kyle - Bridgewater - Health communications

Bowen - Update on remote learning possibilities - Blank learning plan and an example in your packet - all plans have been completed and we will continue to revise as needed

McLaughlin - I saw one of the remote learning plans, look great - out of district payments?

Bowen - Yes we are

Van der Kloot - signing bills for out of district placements

McLaughlin - if schools open in JULY/August - extended school year services?

Bowen - Extended school year, programming of services over summer to stem regression - looks different for different students -

McLaughlin - usually housed in our schools

Bowen - DESE haven't started anything yet - plan on doing remote - do we have the necessary equipment to open schools? We are planning on both -

McLaughlin - are those public meetings?

Bowen - Directors meet with Russell Johnson once a week

McLaughlin - what if the district opens but Medford doesn't?

Bowen - they participate

McLaughlin - Russell Johnson - wave procedural safeguards - Medford is not doing that right?

Bowen - information is included in letter I sent out to families - before May 1st and after that they are null and void

McLaughlin - Thank you very helpful

Supt - Student Engagement during closure - Kim Myles, admin who gave us updated data - positive news - 350 students not as engaged as they could have been (Photo of report)

McLaughlin - closely monitored - inclusive of EL & spec ed - that 34 and 16 are they being closely monitored? But they are being closely monitored

Cushing - They are not represented twice -

Mayor - great progress

Newcomer Program for 2020-2021

Paul T - you have powerpoint and handouts - how to proceed?

Supt - share powerpoint?

Paul T Teixeira - Okay

(Took pic) - notes from past Cmt of whole has the info too

Would like to join the program together - concentrate our program and services - shared resources and increases EL Aides - families don't have to juggle students in different buildings,

McGlynn - is the neighborhood most EL live -

Hybrid models - put 5th grade at McGlynn and then McGlynn Middle

Grades 1-4 at Columbus and 5th at McGlynn

Van der Kloot - This is challenging as you may be aware, teachers have emailed us, concerns voiced, packing up and moving during covid, good idea, but is this the year to do it? All of sudden change their placement

Paul T - I agree - it's a really good year to make the move - everything's changed, so might make logical sense - This plan was made before covid - we won't know what's best for short term, but maybe for long term - waiting a year, isn't going to change that

Van der Kloot - long bus rides are an issue too - 2 of our buildings would have a lot less diverse populations, so that's concern

Paul T - EL - teach students English - but racial balance is a separate issue

Van der Kloot - from an education standpoint, that would best serve population

Paul T - yes, would increase parent participation

Kreatz - pack up classrooms plan?

Paul T - no plan yet, but just to get back into buildings there is no plan - we'd provide support and help get them stuff moved

Kreatz - communicating to parents? Not enough communicating how to inform the parents

Ruseau - huge imbalance - need new district wide racial balance plan - pick one of these options - worst thing to think about is redistricting - not going away - Who's been through redistricting? Where are all the programs? Address issues of racial disparities?

McLaughlin - begs integration too - its the budget that gets put first - as important as cost - is the issue of integration across the district - really appreciate your input - appreciate your teachers reaching out

Graham - what's best for the students don't have to bounce around, that to me feels the right thing for kids - at this moment I'm really concerned about the admin work that would need to be done well - are we biting off more than we can chew? Families might Unintentionally feel short end of stick - so not sure

Paul T - I agree - but things are already in an upheaval, so we could make it seamless for our families - I do believe we can do what's right by our families - again, we don't know what's coming down the pike, but I have no doubts we can successfully pull it off

Ms. Caldwell - The recommendation of Mr. Teixeira is best for the families and students - his heart is with the students and families - if anyone could do it, with admin team - it could be done

Mayor - central admin & teachers?

Paul T - yes

Ruseau - Would 5th grade newcomer team be a part of 6th grade?

Paul T - part of 6th grade team - continuity in programming -

Diane G - hybrid model would work the best - we could take it with no problem - would all be together with other 5th grades and be mainstreamed in the electives

Van der Kloot - not ready to make this decision - a big decision - hard to figure out what is right
- you gave us forewarning - do you need to know now so we can be clear cut -

Paul T - yes, tonight

Van der Kloot - All Columbus vs Columbus /McGlynn

Paul T - Yes, huge rising number of grade 4

Mustone - young children in 2 different schools always a concern - Make a motion he is the director of the program and speaks to families regularly - Best for families - Make a motion to move forward with Columbus and McGlynn model McLaughlin seconded

McLaughlin - seconded it and appreciated Teixeira support of our families - why not make it happen?

Graham - procedural question - do they always come before the school committee? It seems administrative

Paul T - it was voted on by SC in 2017 so looking to undue

Ruseau - when we don't have authority and this is a decision fully within Supt decision - plenty of gray - not our authority

McLaughlin - Motion on floor - has transportation and budget implications

Mayor - Did we or transportation teamwork on the cost for this?

Paul T - we think with our current addresses - the McGlynn Columbus neighborhoods are not far from each other - could maybe use 1 van for Brooks neighborhood students

Paul T - \$23,000 savings - no vans needed

All in favor

Roll Call vote -7-0 motion passes

Ruseau - Make a motion that admin provide a statement if they are planning to redistrict this entire system, as well as programmatic , is it on the table?

Van der Kloot - serious concerns to take up right now - there are so many issues right now, makes no sense right now - a very complicated question

Ruseau - it should have been addressed 5-10 years ago

Van der Kloot - not during a pandemic

Ruseau - I'll withdraw motion and put on agenda

Ruseau/Graham - motion passes

Kreatz - I work 12 months so mtgs would still need to be at 4 PM

Mayor - Before & After school programs - during closure - options to enroll - continue services under

Graham - Motion a couple of hundred years ago - but flexible on due date - but I would like to think strategically about this -

Supt - Ms. Fiedler-Carey - she'll attend roundtables to be part of this discussion and working to come up with plans

Van der Kloot - Ad Hoc Policy request - SC wishes to move it forward - and then at next regularly scheduled meeting Supt would notify when it would ready

Kreatz - in future these Ad Hoc requests or resolutions or Ad Hoc requests - how listed? - a form submitted?

Mayor - have Supt review it for next meeting - great resolution - to just get it started and it's important info

McLaughlin

MOtion to approve as amended

Graham - more of a plan than an Ad HOc report

MOtion passes as amended

World Language Team -

Graham - survey went out to 6th grade class - discussed in March - language preference - meaningful start - I want us to start looking at the data now

McLaughlin - Ad Hoc Report request - amend it - is JUne 15th feasible? - Also ask to consider other languages primary languages? Why wouldn't they wouldn't be considered?

Graham - Ad Hoc Report request procedure does require a date - flexible on a date - regarding other languages? But survey didn't include the other languages - french was discussed due to no feeder from middle

McLaughlin - motion to amend for Ad Hoc procedure? I'll defer to chair

Ruseau - no form - rather a format - name of it, one or more questions to be answered, data included, and history and a date that it's being asked for. Supt can bring it back

McLaughlin - amend to add to motion to supt for amount of work would include

Van der Kloot - Was there already a survey?

Bern - 3rd round to get data - not been easy to obtain - the way the question was asked as a research question - if french was offered would that be your 1st choice?

Ruseau - it has budgetary implications

Van /Graham - to move question

Van der Kloot - Jenny's question - amended to get Supt feedback

Motion passes

Resolutions expresses sincere condolences to William E. Bruce, Margaret Elizabeth Buckley, Carl Pulson, and DiBenedetto

Supt - move it to June 4th, still gathering data

Mayor - Behavioral health - Thur - 4 PM

School Committee round table, May 27th - 4 PM

Monday June 1st - Budget & SC Meeting

Ruseau - adjourn / Graham - 8:24 PM